SEO Changelog — Post: The Ultimate Guide to Your Crab Island Excursion

URL: https://bikkinibottomboat.com/the-ultimate-guide-to-your-crab-island-excursion-in-destin/ · **WP ID:** 2197 (post, Gutenberg blocks; builder flag = Elementor; featured image 1830) · **Audit date:** 2026-10-25 · **Audit page 16 of 24**
Sources: WordPress content and Rank Math fields (site connector), Semrush US data from earlier audits. Semrush has no ranking data for this URL.

1. Summary

Area	Current state	Priority
Booking CTA links to another company	The main call to action, "Book your spot on a Crab Island excursion with Bikkini Bottom...", links the word "excursion" to `https://originalcrabisland.com/services/`, a **different business's website**. Readers ready to book are sent off-site, and the link passes authority to that domain. If it's a related business, still move that link elsewhere. The booking CTA must point to Bikkini Bottom.	**Critical**
Duplicate / thin	About 350 words. "What is Crab Island?" repeats the What Is Crab Island page (ID 2333); "why a captained trip" repeats the Crab Island Tours page and the Shuttle-vs-Rental guide. Focus keyword "Crab Island Guide"; no rankings in Semrush.	**High**
Keyword overlap	"Crab Island excursion" is the phrase the Crab Island Tours page ranks #4 for ("crab island excursions destin fl", 1,300/mo). A second URL using the same phrase risks splitting signals.	**High**
Headings / meta	H4s wrapped in `<strong>`; no H2. SEO title and meta empty.	**Medium**
Useful nugget	States "Our **USCG-licensed captain**". That answers the license question from page 12 (owner to confirm the license type) and should be used on the service and safety pages.	—
Misc	Crab Island link list with inline blue styles; empty paragraph at the end; homepage CTA instead of the booking page.	**Low**

2. Recommendation: merge and redirect (Option A, preferred)

> This post adds nothing the site doesn't already cover better, and it overlaps the site's best-ranking commercial phrase. **Merge its two useful pieces into the Crab Island Tours page, then 301 this URL to `/crab-island-tours-in-destin-fl/`.** That consolidates signals on the page that already ranks #4 for "crab island excursions destin fl".

Content in this post	Action
"What is Crab Island?" recap	Drop. Already covered in depth on /what-is-crab-island/.

"Join the Party, Without the Problems" (3 bullets: no stress, safety / no designated driver, easiest way there)	**Move** to the Crab Island Tours page as an H2 **"Why Book a Captained Crab Island Excursion?"** under "What to Expect". Keep "USCG-licensed captain" and "no designated driver needed".
"Your Perfect Crab Island Day Trip" paragraph	Fold into the Crab Island Tours page "What to Expect" (already rewritten in changelog 2). Reuse the line "No navigating, no anchoring, no cleanup."
CTA	Gone with the post. The tours page has its own booking buttons.

Steps:

1. Add the H2 + bullets above to the Crab Island Tours page (ID 599).
2. Rank Math → Redirections: 301 `/the-ultimate-guide-to-your-crab-island-excursion-in-destin/` → `/crab-island-tours-in-destin-fl/`.
3. Set the post to Draft (keep it for reference), or trash it after 30 days.
4. Update internal links: the homepage "Plan Your Trip" list (changelog 1) and the Crab Island page guide list (changelog 2) had "Ultimate Guide to Your Crab Island Excursion". Remove those items.
5. Featured image 1830 is free to reuse on the tours page gallery if it's a good shot.

3. Option B: keep the post (only if the owner wants a blog version)

If it has to stay, repurpose it so it doesn't compete:

Field	Change to
Angle	**"A Day at Crab Island: Hour-by-Hour Itinerary"**: a narrative itinerary (arrive, cruise out, swim, vendor lunch, dolphin spotting, ride back, dinner) with local tips. Distinct from the "what is", "cost", "what to bring" and "safety" guides.
Slug	`crab-island-day-itinerary` + 301 from the old URL
SEO title	A Day at Crab Island: Hour-by-Hour Itinerary & Local Tips
Meta	Plan the perfect Crab Island day in Destin: when to go, what to do hour by hour, where to eat after, and how to get there without driving a boat.
Focus keyword	crab island tips (20, KD 0)
Headings	H2s: Morning / Midday at the Sandbar / Afternoon / After Your Trip / FAQs. H4s removed.
Links	"Crab Island tour" → tours page (not "excursion"); "what to bring" → packing page; "where to eat" → restaurants post; "sunset cruise" → sunset page.
Category	Crab Island & Boating

4. Fix regardless of option

Issue	Fix	Priority

Outbound CTA to originalcrabisland.com	Remove the link from the booking sentence **today**, even before the merge. If a link to that site is wanted (partner/sister business), put it in a clearly labeled sentence with `rel="noopener"`, not inside the "book with Bikkini Bottom" CTA.	**Critical**
Site-wide check	Search all posts, pages and Elementor data for `originalcrabisland.com` and other competitor/partner domains in CTAs (site connector `search_replace` dry run).	**High**
Captain license	Confirm the "USCG-licensed captain" wording and license type (e.g. Master / OUPV), then use it consistently on the homepage, Crab Island, Safety and FAQ pages.	**Medium**

5. Tracking

Item	Setup
Redirect monitoring	GSC → Pages: confirm the old URL drops out and the tours page picks up any impressions. Rank Math 404 log after 7 days.
Outbound leaks	GA4 outbound click report (enhanced measurement): list the external domains clicked from posts. Catch any other off-site CTAs.
Tours page lift	Watch "crab island excursions destin fl" (#4 baseline) and "crab island tours" (#40) for the merged page.

6. Changelog (implementation checklist)

#	Change	Where	Status
1	**Remove the originalcrabisland.com link from the booking CTA**	Post 2197	To do (urgent)
2	Site-wide search for off-site CTA links	search_replace (dry run)	To do
3	Option A: "Why Book a Captained Crab Island Excursion?" H2 added to the Crab Island Tours page	Page 599	To do
4	Option A: 301 post → /crab-island-tours-in-destin-fl/; post to Draft	Rank Math / Posts	To do
5	Remove "Ultimate Guide to Your Crab Island Excursion" from guide link lists (changelogs 1 & 2)	Elementor	To do
6	(Option B only) Repurpose as the itinerary post per §3	Post	Only if chosen
7	Owner: confirm the captain license type; decide Option A or B; explain the originalcrabisland.com relationship	Owner	Waiting

Next page in queue: **Post: The Ultimate Guide to the Best Restaurants in Destin, FL** (ID 2210), the site's top traffic page.